

and way ahead of Windows in third. BlackBerry have a decent browser, but loses out on expected functions such as browser customisation, and the inability to sync with browsers on other devices did cost it dearly.

EMAIL

BB users are always harping on that OS's superlative e-mail management, but it was something that the non-BB users among us (which is everyone except Robert) never really took seriously. How much better can a BB10 device really be than an Android device, for e-mail? Well, 60% better, judging by our sheet! The BB 10.2 powered Z30 got away with an impressive score of 83.2%, leaving Android and iOS at a distant 53.07 and 46.6 per cent respectively. BBs are truly built with e-mail in mind.

MESSAGING

SMS and MMS are still important to many, especially when you consider that we're also looking at settings to mute conversations, delete, and also block senders. With the amount of SMS spam still circulating, it's still important to be able to control every minute detail of messaging.

SETTINGS AND CUSTOMISATION

As we mentioned before, the ability to access settings and customise is very

important to a certain subset of people (hint: Digit readers), because let's face it we love to tinker with our toys. We've always felt that Android is the most customizable OS out there and our test doesn't prove us wrong. Without a doubt, the most tinker-friendly OS was Android as it lets you tweak just about anything and everything, and we haven't even considered apps yet!

MANAGING CONTACTS AND CALLING

Smart phones are still phones, and given the amount of people we have to keep in touch with these days, although calling may not be the highest priority for most of us, contact management surely is.

The OS that outshone all others here was BlackBerry (we're starting to see a trend here), with Windows not that far behind. Part of the secret to BBs success in this department has to do with its contact management capabilities.

PHOTOGRAPHY

Various stats from around the world will say varying things, but you don't need all that to realise that you've probably clicked more pictures in the last year from your phone than you have with any dedicated camera. Whether it's clicking your surroundings, friends, selfies, or just clicking a piece of paper instead of scanning, you probably wouldn't buy a phone that didn't

have a half decent camera. With social networking demanding more creativity, it's also important that your phone also offer filters, frames and the like to enhance the pictures you click.

We were, at first, very surprised when we found BB pipping the likes of Windows Phone and iOS to take the top spot here, but one needs to remember that we're dealing with stock OSs here and we know for a fact that every other OS has a superlative camera app hidden up its sleeve. Out of the box however, the others are a poor match for BlackBerry.

NOTIFICATIONS

Smartphones are the ultimate communications devices, and the way they communicate with you is by notifying you. Not just merely when someone calls you, but when someone writes on your Facebook wall, mentions you in a tweet, emails you, etc.

Based on our findings, iOS wins the notification war hands down with a whopping score of 69 per cent. BlackBerry is a very distant second with 36.9. For an OS that was, at one time, panned for not implementing a mature notification system to one-up every other Stock OS is quite a feat for iOS.

LOCK SCREEN

A lockscreen may not be an important feature, but you probably don't realise

Tolkien tales, or as a brick to throw at someone, but we're focussing on the rules here and not the exceptions.

Once we'd decided what we needed to look at (which basically covers over a thousand individual features or settings in each of the OSes), we then proceeded to list each and every setting / feature that came into each category.

With over a thousand unique values being noted, by at least two people per OS, this obviously became a massive exercise that took the entire month. Honestly, how you have anything else to read in this issue is still a mystery to us...

After noting down every single feature / setting possible – collating across OSes to ensure that even unique features that were available in

any one OS were looked for in all of the others by at least two people – we then proceeded to list the fastest ways to enable / disable each feature / setting. Sometimes if it was just a question of whether the OS could achieve a certain feature, the answer was listed as either Yes or No, and at others we noted the amount of steps taken. From something as simple as changing your wallpaper to something as complicated as setting up parental controls on a child's phone, we looked at it all, across all the OSes.

Based on the prioritising we've listed above, we also awarded weights and scored each task, and then totalled it in what could only be called the biggest nightmare of all Google Spreadsheets, and arrived at the winner of round 1 of this test.